The Fly

Crawling on the bathroom counter. I am ready.

Step 1: I fix my gaze on him and extend my left hand towards the place where I know sits a small translucent cup. I slowly raise the cup and slowly move it over him, with no break in my focus. I pounce. At this point, as often as not, the fly somehow evades capture and escapes to the safety of three dimensions. This time, however, I see a dark form through the side of the cup, at first buzzing, agitated, then crawling confused on the counter.

Step 2. To my right, unseen, is a piece of thin cardboard laid out for this purpose. I take hold of it and slide it under the cup, by tiny degrees, to allow him time to accept the need to climb up the approaching cardboard cliff.

Step 3. I go to the door separating my home from its environment and crack it open.

Step 4. I return to the cup and cardboard and carefully transport them to the door, which I kick open with my foot.

Step 5. I lift the cup to the open sky. "Live! Live the life you were made for! Multiply! And may your many fly childs follow in your wing flaps."

Step 6. I return to the bathroom and place the cardboard to my right and the cup to my left, so that I may find them again by touch the next time they're needed.

But there's something in the cup. A dark form flies out into the bathroom. I never see him again.